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Additive management system

Abstract

A system including an additive management system configured to oversee hydrate formation in a hydrocarbon extraction system, the additive management system including a flow meter configured to measure a fluid flow rate, a first sensor configured to measure at least one of a fluid property and an environmental condition, and a chemical injection device configured to inject a hydrate inhibitor into a fluid flow.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of, and claims priority to and the benefit of, U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/516,953, entitled “ADDITIVE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM,” filed Apr. 5, 2017, which is a National Stage Entry of, and claims priority to and the benefit of, PCT Application No. PCT/US2015/057878, entitled “ADDITIVE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM,” filed Oct. 28, 2015, which claims priority to and benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/069,729, entitled “Monoethylene Glycol Injection Control System”, filed Oct. 28, 2014, U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/144,178, entitled “Additive Management System,” filed Apr. 7, 2015, U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/186,050, entitled “Additive Management System,” filed Jun. 29, 2015, and U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/173,750, entitled “Method and System for Measuring the Injection Rate of a Chemical in a Fluid Flow Stream,” filed Jun. 10, 2015, the disclosures of which are herein incorporated by reference in their entireties for all purposes.

BACKGROUND

(1) This section is intended to introduce the reader to various aspects of art that may be related to various aspects of the present invention, which are described and/or claimed below. This discussion is believed to be helpful in providing the reader with background information to facilitate a better understanding of the various aspects of the present invention. Accordingly, it should be understood that these statements are to be read in this light, and not as admissions of prior art.

(2) Hydrate formation in hydrocarbon extraction operations is an industry wide concern. Hydrates are formations of ice and gas that may form due to high pressures and low temperatures in hydrocarbon extraction environments. In order to block hydrate formation, a variety of hydrate inhibitors are used, such as mono-ethylene glycol. These hydrate inhibitors may block hydrate formation by lowering the freezing point of water. Unfortunately, hydrate inhibitors may be used excessively to prevent hydrate formation, which unnecessarily increases the cost of hydrocarbon extraction operations.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) Various features, aspects, and advantages of the present invention will become better understood when the following detailed description is read with reference to the accompanying figures in which like characters represent like parts throughout the figures, wherein:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a schematic view of an embodiment of a hydrocarbon extraction system with an additive management system;
- (3) FIG. 2 is a schematic view of an embodiment of an additive management system;
- (4) FIG. 3 is a schematic view of an embodiment of an additive management system coupled to a wellhead system;
- (5) FIG. 4 is a schematic view of an embodiment of an additive management system coupled to a wellhead system;
- (6) FIG. 5 is a schematic view of an embodiment of an additive management system coupled to a wellhead system;
- (7) FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional view of an embodiment of a tubing hanger of a hydrocarbon extraction system including a sensor;
- (8) FIG. 7 is a flow diagram of a method for controlling hydrate formation of a hydrocarbon extraction system; and
- (9) FIG. 8 is a flow diagram of a method for controlling a ratio of an injected chemical to water in a fluid flow.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF SPECIFIC EMBODIMENTS

- (10) One or more specific embodiments of the present invention will be described below. These described embodiments are only exemplary of the present invention. Additionally, in an effort to provide a concise description of these exemplary embodiments, all features of an actual implementation may not be described in the specification. It should be appreciated that in the development of any such actual implementation, as in any engineering or design project, numerous implementation-specific decisions must be made to achieve the developers' specific goals, such as compliance with system-related and business-related constraints, which may vary from one implementation to another. Moreover, it should be appreciated that such a development effort might be complex and time consuming, but would nevertheless be a routine undertaking of design, fabrication, and manufacture for those of ordinary skill having the benefit of this disclosure.
- (11) The present disclosure is directed to embodiments of an additive management system configured to determine and monitor one or more conditions of a hydrocarbon extraction system, such as a hydrate condition (e.g., hydrate formation). In order to determine and monitor the hydrate condition, the additive management system includes a controller that receives feedback (e.g., data) from one or several flow meters, sensors, chemical injection metering valves, etc. of the hydrocarbon extraction system. The controller or another device (e.g., computer) uses the feedback in algorithms, modeling programs, and/or lookup tables to determine the hydrate condition. For example, the controller may determine a likelihood of hydrate formation based on an analysis of the feedback.

(12) Additionally, in certain embodiments, the additive management system may be configured to provide recommendations to a user based on the hydrate condition (e.g., hydrate formation is likely to occur) to reduce or block hydrate formation. For example, the additive management system may provide recommendations to adjust an amount or flow rate of an injected hydrate inhibitor. In some embodiments, the additive management system may automatically adjust an amount or flow rate of an injected hydrate inhibitor to reduce or block hydrate formation. Furthermore, the additive management system may enable precise and/or targeted monitoring and/or control of hydrate formation throughout the hydrocarbon extraction system. In particular, the additive management system may provide recommendations and/or adjustments for the hydrate inhibitor injection that are specific for and/or tailored for one or more specific locations in the hydrocarbon extraction system. For example, the additive management system may be configured to distribute hydrate inhibitor (or another injected chemical)

(13) Further, in some embodiments, the additive management system may be configured to inject a chemical into a fluid flow of the hydrocarbon extraction system and to determine a ratio of the injected chemical to relative water in the fluid flow. For example, the additive management system may inject one or more chemicals, such as hydrate inhibitors (e.g., thermodynamic inhibitors and/or kinetic inhibitors), pH modifiers, and/or scale inhibitors. The additive management system may determine the ratio of the injected chemical relative to water based at least in part on feedback from one or more optical sensors, feedback from one or more conductivity sensors, or a combination thereof. Additionally, the additive management system may be configured to provide recommendations to adjust the flow rate and/or amount of the injected chemical or to automatically adjust the flow rate and/or amount of the injected chemical based on the ratio of the injected chemical relative to water. For example, the additive management system may compare the ratio to a threshold (e.g., above a lower threshold or below an upper threshold) or threshold range (e.g., between upper and lower thresholds) and may provide recommendations to adjust or may automatically adjust the flow rate and/or amount of the injected chemical based on the comparison.

(14) FIG. 1 is a schematic view of an embodiment of a hydrocarbon extraction system **10** with an additive management system **12** that determines and monitors one or more parameters or conditions of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. For example, as described in more detail below, the additive management system **12** may determine or monitor a hydrate condition (e.g., hydrate formation) and/or a ratio or proportion of a chemical (e.g., a hydrate inhibitor) relative to water in a fluid flow. Additionally, as described in more detail below, the additive management system **12** may provide recommendations to a user, monitoring system, or control system relating to recommended adjustments for one or more parameters of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10** and/or may automatically adjust one or more parameters of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10** based on the determined parameters and conditions of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10** (e.g., via a control system). Further, the additive management system **12** may enable precise and/or targeted monitoring and/or control of parameters and conditions throughout the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. In order to monitor and/or control the one or more parameters and/or conditions of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**, the additive management system **12** may include sensors **14** (e.g., conductivity probes, solid particulate sensors, temperature sensors, pressure sensors, optical sensors, salinity sensors, water sensors, etc.), chemical injection metering valves (CIMV) **16**, hydrate inhibitor regeneration systems **18**, flow meters **20** (e.g., wet-gas flow meter, multi-phase flow meter), fluid control devices **22**, and control systems **24**.

(15) As illustrated, the hydrocarbon extraction system **10** may include one or more wellhead systems **26** with a wellhead **28** coupled to a production tree **30** (e.g., Christmas tree). The wellhead systems **26** couple to a well **32** that enables hydrocarbon extraction (e.g., oil and/or natural gas) from a subterranean reservoir **34**. As the hydrocarbons exit the well **32**, the wellhead system **26** may direct the hydrocarbons to the surface through risers **36** for collection and/or processing at a rig **38** or shore facility. In some embodiments, multiple wells **32** may be part of the hydrocarbon

extraction system **10**. These wells **32** and wellhead systems **26** may couple to a manifold **40** with a jumper system **42** (e.g., jumper cables, pipes, etc.). Accordingly, the rig **38** or shore facility may then couple to the manifold **40** enabling fluid communication with multiple wells **32**.

(16) During extraction operations, additional substances (e.g., water and sediment) may flow out of the wells **32** with the hydrocarbon fluid flow. As the water moves with the hydrocarbons, water (e.g., freezing water) and natural gas components may combine to form hydrates due to high pressures and low temperatures in the hydrocarbon extraction environment. However, as described below, the additive management system **12** may monitor a hydrate condition (e.g., hydrate formation) of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10** and may reduce, block, or inhibit formation of the hydrates by injecting hydrate inhibitors (e.g., mono-ethylene glycol, methanol, kinetic hydrate inhibitors, anti-agglomerates, etc.) in the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**.

(17) As illustrated, in some embodiments of the disclosure, the additive management system **12** includes in some embodiments of the disclosure, one more CIMVs **16** that inject one or more chemicals into the fluid flow coming out of the wells **32**. For example, one or more CIMVs **16** may inject hydrate inhibitors (e.g., mono-ethylene glycol, methanol, kinetic hydrate inhibitors, thermodynamic inhibitors, anti-agglomerates), pH modifiers, and/or scale inhibitors. In some embodiments, each wellhead system **26** (e.g., each branch of the Christmas tree **30** and/or each wellhead **28**) may include a respective CIMV **16** for chemical injection. In certain embodiments, the manifold **40** may also include one or more CIMVs **16** that inject chemicals. In some embodiments, hydrocarbon extraction system **10** may include CIMVs **16** in one or more of the wellhead systems **26**, the riser **36**, the manifold **40**, and/or other locations in the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**.

(18) By including CIMVs **16** in each of the wellhead systems **26** and/or at other locations in the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**, the additive management system **12** is able to tailor/control (e.g., provide an appropriate amount—not too much, not too little of) the flow of chemicals (e.g., hydrate inhibitors) in different areas of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. That is, the additive management system **12** may be configured to control a plurality of CIMVs **16**, which may be disposed in different locations (e.g., different wellhead systems **26**, the riser **36**, the manifold **40**, etc.) of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**, and the additive management system **12** may be configured to control two or more CIMVs **16** or each CIMV **16** of the plurality of CIMVs **16** differently to provide a differential distribution of chemicals at the various locations. For example, the additive management system **12** may cause a first CIMV **16** to inject a first amount and/or first flow rate of a chemical and may cause a second CIMV **16** to inject a second amount and/or second flow rate of a chemical that is different from the first amount and/or first flow rate. Further, as will be described in more detail below, the additive management system **12** may monitor hydrate formation for one or more locations of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10** and may determine an amount and/or flow rate of hydrate inhibitor to inject using each CIMV **16** of the one or more locations, and the amount and/or flow rate of the hydrate inhibitor may be specific for and/or optimized for the particular location. For example, some wells **32** may produce or have higher concentrations of water than other wells **32**. In response, the additive management system **12** may control one or more CIMVs **16** to increase hydrate inhibitor injection at wellhead systems **26** that experience significant water flow, while controlling one or more different CIMVs **16** to reduce hydrate inhibitor injection at wellhead systems **26** that produce small amounts of water. Moreover, the additive management system **12** may account for environmental conditions that enable hydrate formation such as temperature, pressure, and salinity. For example, a first well **32** that is at a lower temperature and/or higher pressure than a second well **32** may receive more hydrate inhibitor injection than the second well **32**, because the temperatures and/or pressures at the first well **32** are more likely to produce hydrates. In other words, the additive management system **12** may control one or more CIMVs **16** to increase hydrate inhibitor injection at wells **32** that experience environmental conditions favorable to hydrate formation (e.g., low temperatures and/or high

pressures) and/or may control one or more CIMVs **16** to reduce hydrate inhibitor injection at wells **32** that do not.

(19) As explained above, the additive management system **12** may include a variety of sensors **14** (e.g., conductivity probes, solid particulate sensors, temperature sensors, pressure sensors, optical sensors, salinity sensors, water sensors, etc.) and flow meters **20** (e.g., wet-gas flow meters, multi-phase flow meters). The sensors **14** may measure one or more conditions and/or parameters of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. For example, as will be described in more detail below, the sensors **14** may measure and/or generate feedback relating to temperature, pressure, salinity, conductivity, electromagnetic radiation, attenuation of one or more wavelengths of light, water content (e.g., water cut) in a fluid flow, or any other suitable parameter. Additionally, the flow meters **20** may measure the flow rate of a fluid (e.g., flow). In some embodiments, the multi-phase flow meters **20** may measure the full three-phase performance over the entire gas volume fraction (GVF) and water liquid ratio (WLR) ranges.

(20) The sensors **14** and the flow meters **20** may be placed in different locations in the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. For example, in some embodiments, the sensors **14** and/or the flow meters **20** may be disposed in one or more of the wellhead systems **26** (e.g., each wellhead system **26**), the manifold **40**, the riser **36**, the pipes of the jumper system **42**, and/or other locations in the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. In certain embodiments, the sensors **14** and/or flow meters **20** may be mounted on a pipe section downstream of a bend, change in cross-sectional area, or other point to facilitate a liquid rich area. In some embodiments, at least one sensor **14** and/or at least one flow meter **20** may be disposed proximate to (e.g., upstream and/or downstream of) each CIMV **16**.

(21) By placing the sensors **14** and the flow meters **20** about different locations of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**, the additive management system **12** may measure or determine parameters and/or conditions in the hydrocarbon extraction system **10** at each location and may enable the control systems **24** to accurately control injection of one or more chemicals (e.g., hydrate inhibitors) at each location based on the parameters and/or conditions at the respective location. That is, the amount and/or flow rate of chemical injected may be individualized and/or specific for each CIMV **16** and/or for each desired location of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10** (e.g., each wellhead system **26**, the Christmas tree **30**, the riser **36**, the manifold **40**, the jumper system **42**, or any combination thereof) based on the parameters and/or conditions in a region proximate to each CIMV **16** and/or at each desired location. For example, in some embodiments, the control systems **24** may use feedback (e.g., signals) from the sensors **14** and/or the flow meters **20** to determine a hydrate condition for one or more locations (e.g., each location) having the sensors **14** and/or flow meters **20**, and the control systems **24** may determine an amount and/or flow rate of hydrate inhibitor to inject using one or more CIMVs **16** (e.g., each CIMV **16**) based at least in part on the hydrate condition for the location proximate to the respective CIMV **16**.

(22) FIG. 2 is a schematic view of an embodiment of an additive management system **12**. As illustrated, the additive management system **12** includes one or more control systems **24** that communicate with and/or control various sensors **14**, flow meters **20**, flow control device **22** (e.g., choke), CIMVs **16**, and hydrate inhibitor regeneration systems **18**. As will be explained in detail below, the control system (e.g., controller) **24** includes one or more processors **60** that execute instructions stored by one or more memories **62** (e.g., tangible, non-transitory memory devices) to control the additive management system **12**. During operation, the controller **24** may receive feedback from the various sensors **14**, such as one or more pressure sensors **64**, one or more temperature sensors **66**, one or more conductivity probes (e.g., conductivity sensors) **68**, and/or one or more optical sensors **70**. In some embodiments, the pressure sensor **64** and the temperature sensor **66** may be combined (e.g., a pressure and temperature transmitter (PTTx)). Additionally, the controller **24** may receive feedback from the various flow meters **20** (e.g., wet-gas flow meter, multi-phase flow meter). The controller **24** may be operatively coupled to the sensors **14** and the flow meters **20** via any suitable communication link, such as, for example, RS-422, RS-435, RS-

485, Ethernet, controller area network (CAN) (e.g., CAN bus, CANopen), optical fibers, and/or wireless communication.

(23) The controller **24** may determine measurement data (e.g., real-time or substantially real-time measurement data) based on the feedback from the sensors **14** and/or the feedback from the flow meters **20**. For example, the measurement data may include one or more conditions (e.g., environmental conditions) of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**, such as pressure and/or temperature. Additionally, the measurement data may include one or more flow characteristics (e.g., flow parameters) of a fluid flow in the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**, such as flow rate (e.g. mass flow rate), fluid density, salinity, composition, concentration, and so forth. In particular, the controller **24** may determine flow characteristics of the process fluid (e.g., the hydrocarbon flow) upstream of a chemical injection point and/or flow characteristics of the process fluid downstream of a chemical injection point after mixing with the injected chemical. For example, as will be described below in FIGS. 3-5, the additive management system **12** may include sensors **14** and/or flow meters **20** that are disposed upstream and/or downstream of a CIMV **16**. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may use the feedback from the upstream and the downstream sensors **14** and/or flow meters **20** to determine one or more flow parameters. For example, the controller **24** may compare measurements upstream and downstream to determine a ratio of an injected chemical relative to water, content of water, etc.

(24) Further, it should be noted that the controller **24** may determine flow characteristics for one or more components of a fluid flow. For example, the fluid flow may include water, oil, gas, hydrogen sulfide, carbon dioxide, nitrogen, salts, and/or one or more injected chemicals (e.g., hydrate inhibitors, pH modifiers, scale inhibitors, etc.). In some embodiments, the controller **24** may determine the flow rate (e.g., mass flow rate) and/or fluid density for one or more components of the fluid flow.

(25) In certain embodiments, the controller **24** may determine an amount, proportion, percentage, or concentration of one or more components in the fluid flow relative to the total fluid flow. For example, the controller **24** may determine the water content (e.g., water cut) in the fluid flow, which may be a proportion, percentage, or concentration of water relative to the fluid flow. Additionally, the controller **24** may be configured to determine an injected chemical content in the fluid flow, which may be a proportion, percentage, or concentration of the injected chemical relative to the fluid flow. However, it should be appreciated that the controller **24** may be configured to determine the percentage of any suitable component in the fluid flow. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may determine the amount (e.g., proportion, percentage, or concentration) of one or more components in the fluid flow relative to the total fluid flow based on feedback from one or more conductivity probes **68**. For example, the one or more conductivity probes **68** may be microwave open-ended coaxial probes. In certain embodiments, the one or more conductivity probes **68** may be conductivity probes as described in U.S. Pat. No. 6,831,470, which is incorporated by reference in its entirety herein for all purposes, and the controller **24** may use any of the methods and techniques described in U.S. Pat. No. 6,831,470 for processing signals from the conductivity probe to determine the amounts of the components in a fluid. For example, in one embodiment, the conductivity probe **68** may generate an alternating current electrical signal (e.g., a reference signal), which may be reflected by the fluid and detected by the conductivity probe (e.g., reflected signal). The reflected signal may be compared to the reference signal to determine the electromagnetic properties of the fluid, which may be used to determine the amount of one or more components in the fluid flow (e.g., using one or more algorithms, models, look-up tables, etc.). For example, the amplitude attenuation and phase shift between the reference signal and the reflected signal may be used to derive the complex reflection coefficient of the fluid flow, the fluid conductivity, and/or the fluid permittivity.

(26) In some embodiments, the controller **24** may determine the amount (e.g., proportion, percentage, or concentration) of one or more components in the fluid flow relative to the total fluid

flow based on feedback from one or more optical sensors **70**. The optical sensors **70** may be infrared, reflectance-type sensors. In some embodiments, the optical sensors **70** may be configured to emit light in the mid-wavelength infrared region, the long-wavelength infrared region, and/or the far-infrared region. For example, the optical sensors **70** may be configured to emit one or more wavelengths of light in the range of 2 micrometers (μm) to 50 μm , 2.5 μm to 15 μm , 3 μm to 12 μm , or any other suitable range. In particular, the optical sensors **70** may be configured to emit light at one or more wavelengths corresponding to absorption peaks of one or more components in the fluid. For example, the optical sensor **70** may emit a first wavelength of light with an absorption peak for water, a second wavelength of light with an absorption peak for an injected chemical (e.g., hydrate inhibitor), a third wavelength of light with an absorption peak for oil, and so forth. Additionally, the optical sensors **70** may be configured to detect light (e.g., in the mid-wavelength infrared region, the long-wavelength infrared region, and/or the far-infrared region) after the emitted light has interacted with the fluid flow. In some embodiments, the optical sensors **70** may be configured to emit and detect a plurality of wavelengths of light corresponding to various substances in the fluid flow. The controller **24** may be configured to determine the amounts of one or more components in the fluid flow based on the detected light (e.g., reflected light).

(27) Further, by using the conductivity probes **68** and/or the optical sensors **70**, the controller **24** may be configured to detect very low amounts of water in the fluid flow. For example, the controller **24** may detect water in a fluid flow when the water content is between approximately 10 parts per million (ppm) and 500 ppm, 30 ppm and 250 ppm, or 50 ppm and 100 ppm. In some situations, the water content may not be measurable (e.g., water concentration below the level measured by sensors). In these situations, the controller **24** may use a modeling program (e.g., computer-based modeling program, physics-based modeling program) to predict the amount of water flowing through the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. Additionally, as will be described in more detail below, in certain embodiments, the controller **24** may determine an amount, proportion, percentage, or concentration of one or more components in the fluid flow relative to one or more other components in the fluid flow based on feedback from the conductivity probes **68**, feedback from the optical sensors **70**, or both. For example, the controller **24** may be configured to determine a ratio of an injected chemical relative to water in the fluid flow.

(28) Additionally, in some embodiments, the controller **24** may be configured to receive feedback from the sensors **14** and/or the flow meters **20** for verification and/or redundancy purposes. For example, the controller **24** may be configured to receive feedback from a conductivity probe **68** and feedback from an optical sensor **70** that are disposed proximate to one another in the same general location in the hydrocarbon extraction system **10** such that the flow characteristics of the fluid as it flows by the conductivity probe **68** are substantially the same as the flow characteristics of the fluid as it flows by the optical sensor **70**. In this manner, if the conductivity probe **68** fails or malfunctions, the controller **24** may still determine parameters (e.g., the water content and injected chemical content) based on feedback from the optical sensor **70** and vice versa. In this manner, the conductivity probe **68** and the optical sensor **70** may be redundant.

(29) Further, the controller **24** may be configured to compare one or more parameters determined based on feedback from the conductivity probe **68** to the same one or more parameters determined based on feedback from the optical sensor **70** to verify and/or reduce uncertainty in the determined parameters. For example, the controller **24** may compare a first value of the water content and a first value of the injected chemical content determined based on feedback from the conductivity probe **68** to a second value of the water content and a second value of the injected chemical content, respectively, determined based on feedback from the optical sensor **70**. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may determine a difference between a first value of a parameter determined from feedback from the conductivity probe **68** and a second value of the parameter determined from feedback from the optical sensor **70** and may compare the difference to the threshold, which may be stored in the memory **62**. In certain embodiments, the controller **24** may

determine a level of certainty for the determined measurement based on the comparison. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may be configured to provide a warning or an alarm in response to a determination that the difference is greater than the threshold, which may be indicative of an undesirably high level of uncertainty for the determined and/or may be indicative of a failure or malfunction of the conductivity probe **68** and/or the optical sensor **70**. For example, the controller **24** may be operatively coupled to a user interface **72**, which may include a display and/or a speaker, and may cause the user interface **72** to provide the warning or alarm.

(30) Still further, in some embodiments, each CIMV **16** may include a flow meter **20** to generate feedback relating to the chemical injection flow rate. In one embodiment, each CIMV **16** may include an ultrasonic flow meter **20** configured to measure a range of flow rates between approximately 0.5 liters per hour to 26,500 liters per hour, or more. As noted above, the controller **24** may control each CIMV **16** to inject a chemical at a designated or assigned injection rate. To verify that each CIMV **16** is injecting the chemical at its respective assigned injection rate, the controller **24** may compare the assigned injection rate to an injection rate determined based on feedback from the flow meter **20** of the respective CIMV **16** to confirm or verify the actual injection rate of the chemical. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may provide a warning or alarm (e.g., via the user interface **72**) if a difference between the assigned injection rate and the determined injection rate is greater than a threshold, which may be stored in the memory **62**. For example, a difference that is greater than the threshold may be indicative of a failure or malfunction of the CIMV **16**.

(31) As noted above, the sensors **14** and the flow meters **20** may be disposed about in a plurality of different locations of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. To enable targeted monitoring and/or control of parameters and conditions of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10** in the different locations, the controller **24** may be configured to associate feedback from each sensor **14** and feedback from each flow meter **20** with the location of the respective sensor **14** or flow meter **20**. For example, in some embodiments, each sensor **14** and each flow meter **20** may be coupled to the controller **24** via an individual channel or a separate pinout in a multibus, and the controller **24** may determine the location of the feedback from each sensor **14** and each flow meter **20** based on the channel or pinout from which the controller **23** received the feedback. In certain embodiments, one or more of the sensors **14** and one or more of the flow meters **20** may include a tag or memory device **73**, which may be configured to store information about the respective sensor **14** or flow meter **20**. For example, the tag or memory device **73** may store identification information (e.g., an identification number, a unique identification number, etc.) and/or location information. The sensors **14** and the flow meters **20** may be configured to transmit the information from the tag or memory device **73** to the controller **24** with the generated feedback, and the controller **24** may determine the location of the sensors **14** and the flow meters **20**, and therefore the generated feedback, based on the information. In some embodiments, the memory **62** may store a lookup table or database linking the information to the respective location, and the controller **24** may access the lookup table or database using the information to determine the location. It should be appreciated that the above-mentioned examples are not intended to be limiting, and any suitable techniques for determining the location of the sensors **14** and the flow meters **20** may be used.

(32) The controller **24** may use the determined measurement data to determine one or more hydrate conditions for the hydrocarbon extraction system **12**. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may determine a plurality of hydrate conditions for a plurality of locations about the hydrocarbon extraction system **12** using the measurement data from the plurality of sensors **14** and flow meters **20** and the information stored in the tags **73** of the sensors **14** and flow meters **20**. For example, the controller **24** may determine a hydrate condition for each wellhead system **26**, a hydrate condition for one or more locations about the riser **36** (e.g., at different depths along the riser **36**), a hydrate condition for the manifold **40**, a hydrate condition for one or more locations about the pipes of the jumper system **42**, and so forth.

(33) In order to determine the one or more hydrate conditions (e.g., whether the water in the fluid flow will form or is likely to form hydrates), the controller **24** may be configured to use the measurement data with one or more modeling programs, algorithms, hydrate formation curves, look-up tables, databases, or any combination thereof. For example, the controller **24** may include one or more modeling programs, algorithms, hydrate formation curves, look-up tables, and/or databases stored in the memory **62** that the processor **60** executes or accesses to determine hydrate formation. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may communicate with another computer(s) **74** that include one or more processors **76** and one or more memories **78** that run the modeling programs, algorithms, hydrate formation curves, look-up tables, and/or databases. In some embodiments, the computer **74** may receive the measurement data directly from the sensors **14**, flow meters **20**, etc. and/or from the controller **24**.

(34) In particular, the modeling programs, algorithms, hydrate formation curves, look-up tables, and/or databases may predict or estimate the likelihood of hydrate formation (e.g., the hydrate condition) based on different values of at least one parameter of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. For example, the modeling programs, algorithms, hydrate formation curves, look-up tables, and/or databases may predict or estimate the likelihood of hydrate formation based on one or more parameters of a hydrocarbon fluid flow, such as temperature, pressure, flow rate (e.g., flow rate of water, flow rate of oil, flow rate of gas), fluid density, salinity, composition (e.g., relative amounts of oil, gas, water, carbon dioxide, hydrogen sulfide, nitrogen, hydrate inhibitor, or any other component), water content, and/or hydrate inhibitor content. In some embodiments, the modeling programs, algorithms, hydrate formation curves, look-up tables, and/or databases may define one or more boundary conditions for the one or more parameters such that values of the one or more parameters (e.g., alone or in combination with other parameters) that meet or violate the one or more boundary conditions are likely to result in hydrate formation.

(35) In certain embodiments, the memory **62** and/or the memory **78** may store a plurality of modeling programs, algorithms, hydrate formation curves, look-up tables, and/or databases that each predict or estimate the likelihood of hydrate formation based on a different parameter or a different combination of parameters. By way of example, the memory **62** may store a first modeling program that estimates the likelihood of hydrate formation based on temperature, a second modeling program that estimates the likelihood of hydrate formation based on temperature and pressure, a third modeling program that estimates the likelihood of hydrate formation based on temperature, pressure, and water content, and a fourth modeling program that estimates the likelihood of hydrate formation based on temperature, pressure, water content, and hydrate inhibitor content. In such embodiments, the controller **24** may be configured to select a modeling program, algorithm, hydrate formation curve, look-up table, and/or database based on the parameters determined by the controller **24** using the feedback from the sensors **14** and flow meters **20**. For example, the controller **24** may select the second modeling program if the controller **24** determines pressure and temperature and may select the third modeling program if the controller **24** determines pressure, temperature, and water content. In some embodiments, the memory **62** and/or the memory **78** may also store a level of certainty for each of the plurality of modeling programs, algorithms, hydrate formation curves, look-up tables, and/or databases, which may increase with the number of parameters used by the respective modeling program, algorithm, hydrate formation curve, look-up table, or database. That is, the determination of hydrate formation may have a higher level of certainty when more information (e.g., more parameters) is used. Further, in some embodiments, the memory **62** may store a plurality of modeling programs that model different states of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. For example, the modeling programs may model start-up, steady-state, look ahead scenarios (e.g., planned shut-in, unplanned shut-in, shut down, etc.), among others. Further, in some embodiments, the modeling programs may include a real-time transient production simulator configured to enable presentation of flow variables in real time between points of measurements. In some embodiments, the real-time transient production

simulator can be used for forecasting and providing what-if scenarios from current conditions, yielding live estimates of cool-down times, no-touch times, and other information for hydrate management. Further, alarms (e.g., alarms triggered by the real-time transient production simulator, alarms triggered by the modeling programs, etc.) may be configured to notify control room operators of potential operational issues before they occur.

(36) In operation, the controller **24** (or the computer **74**) may determine the value of at least one parameter of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10** based on feedback from at least one sensor **14**, feedback from at least one flow meter **20**, or both, and may use the value of the at least one parameter in at least one modeling program, algorithm, hydrate formation curve, look-up table, or database to determine the hydrate conditions (e.g., the likelihood of hydrate formation). As noted above, in some embodiments, the controller **24** may select a modeling program, algorithm, hydrate formation curve, look-up table, or database based on the parameters determined by the controller **24**. Additionally, if the controller **24** determines that hydrate formation is likely, the controller **24** may determine an amount and/or flow rate of a hydrate inhibitor to inject to reduce or block hydrate formation. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may use the modeling program, algorithm, hydrate formation curve, look-up table, and/or database to determine the amount and/or flow rate of the hydrate inhibitor to inject based on the hydrate condition. For example, the controller **24** may input one or more values of one or more parameters into a modeling program, and the modeling program may output both the hydrate condition and an amount and/or flow rate of hydrate inhibitor to inject based on the hydrate condition.

(37) In some embodiments, the controller **24** may be configured to execute one or more algorithms to determine an amount and/or a flow rate of hydrate inhibitor to inject based on the hydrate condition. For example, in one embodiment, the controller **24** may be configured to use the Hammerschmidt equation, which is provided below:

$$(38) \quad x = \frac{d \times M \times 100}{K + d \times M},$$

where x is the concentration of the hydrate inhibitor in weight percent, d is the depression of the hydrate point in degrees Celsius, M is the molecular weight of the hydrate inhibitor, and K is a dimensionless constant for the particular hydrate inhibitor. In particular, the controller **24** may determine a desired depression of the hydrate point (i.e., d) to reduce or block hydrate formation based on the determined hydrate condition, and the controller **24** may determine (e.g., solve for) the concentration of hydrate inhibitor to inject based on the desired depression of the hydrate point. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may determine the flow rate (e.g., mass flow rate) of hydrate inhibitor to inject based on the determined concentration of hydrate inhibitor and the flow rate (e.g., mass flow rate) of water in the fluid flow. The hydrate inhibitor may become diluted after it is injected into the hydrocarbon fluid flow and mixes with other substances, which may decrease the concentration of the hydrate inhibitor and may decrease the effectiveness of the hydrate inhibitor. The diluted hydrate inhibitor may be referred to as rich hydrate inhibitor, while the higher purity hydrate inhibitor (e.g., the hydrate inhibitor reclaimed using the hydrate inhibitor regeneration systems **18** and/or the hydrate inhibitor injected using the CIMVs **16**) may be referred to as lean hydrate inhibitor. In some embodiments, x may be the concentration of the rich hydrate inhibitor, and the controller **24** may determine the mass flow of hydrate inhibitor to inject based on the mass flow of water, the concentration of the rich hydrate inhibitor, and the concentration of lean hydrate inhibitor, which may be known or determined from the hydrate inhibitor regeneration systems **18**. For example, the controller **24** may determine the mass flow of hydrate inhibitor to inject using the following equation:

$$(39) \quad m_I = m_W \times (x_L - x),$$

where $m_{\text{sub.i}}$ is the mass flow of the hydrate inhibitor (e.g., kg/d), $m_{\text{sub.W}}$ is the mass flow of water (e.g., kg/d), x is the concentration of the rich hydrate inhibitor (e.g., weight percent), and $x_{\text{sub.L}}$ is the concentration of the lean hydrate inhibitor (e.g., mass percent).

(40) Further, the controller **24** and/or the computer **74** may determine hydrate condition and the

amount and/or flow rate of hydrate inhibitor to inject for a plurality of locations about the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. For example, the controller **24** may determine hydrate condition and the amount and/or flow rate of hydrate inhibitor to inject for each area or region including a CIMV **16**. In some embodiments, the controller **24** (e.g., using the modeling programs) may be configured to forecast or extrapolate measurement data (e.g., determined from the sensors **14** and the flow meters **20**) to determine hydrate conditions and/or amounts and/or flow rates of hydrate inhibitor to inject for other locations of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10** that do not include the sensors **14** and/or the flow meters **20**. However, the forecasted or extrapolated information may have a lower level of certainty than the measurement data, but may be helpful in controlling hydrate conditions throughout the entire hydrocarbon extraction system **10** with a limited number of sensors **14**.

(41) If the controller **24** and/or the computer **74** determines that hydrate formation is likely or will be likely in a future scenario, the controller **24** and/or computer **74** may advise or warn an operator through the user interface **72**. In particular, the controller **24** and/or the computer **72** may cause the user interface **72** to display an indication that hydrate formation is likely and to display a recommended amount and/or flow rate of hydrate inhibitor to inject to reduce or block the hydrate formation. As will be appreciated, in embodiments in which the additive management system **12** determines a hydrate condition and an amount and/or flow rate of hydrate inhibitor to inject for a plurality of locations about the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**, the user interface **72** may also display an indication of the location for each hydrate condition and recommendation for the amount and/or flow rate of hydrate inhibitor to inject. In some embodiments, the user interface **72** may also display a level of certainty for the respective hydrate condition and/or recommended amount and/or flow rate of hydrate inhibitor to inject. For example, the level of certainty may be determined by the controller **24** and may be based on a level of certainty of the modeling program (or hydrate formation curve, look-up table, algorithm, database, etc.) used, as well as any redundant measurements (e.g., feedback from the conductivity probe **68** and feedback from the optical sensor **70**, etc.) used by the controller **24**. The operator may then provide instructions to the additive management system **12** to increase, start, decrease, and/or stop hydrate inhibitor injection through one or more CIMVs **16**. In particular, the operator may provide instructions to the additive management system **12** to adjust hydrate inhibitor injection through the one or more CIMVs **16** using the recommended hydrate inhibitor injection settings (e.g., flow rate, amount, and/or location) determined by the controller **24** and/or the computer **74**.

(42) In some embodiments, the additive management system **12** may automatically adjust hydrate inhibitor injection based on sensor **14** and flow meter **20** feedback. In particular, the additive management system **12** may control one or more CIMVs **16** to automatically adjust hydrate inhibitor injection based on a determined amount and/or flow rate of hydrate inhibitor to inject to reduce or block a determined hydrate condition. Once the CIMVs **16** are activated, the controller **24** and/or computer **74** may monitor the amount of hydrate inhibitor injected into the fluid flow and may update the modeling programs based on the amount of hydrate inhibitor injected. For example, the controller **24** and/or the computer **74** may continue to monitor feedback from the sensors **14** and the flow meters **20** to determine updated hydrate conditions and to determine updated amounts and/or flow rates of hydrate inhibitor to inject. In some embodiments, the modeling programs may be smart or learning modeling programs that may be configured to learn based on historical data.

(43) In some embodiments, the additive management system **12** may also be configured to monitor the hydrate inhibitor regeneration system **18**. During operation, the hydrate inhibitor regeneration system **18** removes hydrate inhibitor from the fluid flow when it reaches the rig **38**. As noted above, the concentration of the hydrate inhibitor entering the hydrate inhibitor regeneration system **18** may be rich from dilution with other substances, which reduces the effectiveness of the hydrate inhibitor. Thus, by separating the hydrate inhibitor from the fluid flow, the hydrate inhibitor regeneration system **18** may recover lean hydrate inhibitor that has a higher concentration than the

rich hydrate inhibitor, which may reduce the amount of hydrate inhibitor used. In some embodiments, the hydrate inhibitor regeneration system **18** may be configured to determine the concentration of the rich and lean hydrate inhibitor. As noted above, by measuring the concentration (e.g., strength, potency) of the hydrate inhibitor before and after injection (e.g., rich and lean concentrations), the controller **24** may determine how much hydrate inhibitor should be injected to block hydrate formation. The controller **24** and/or computer **74** may also receive input from the hydrate inhibitor regeneration system **18** indicating how much hydrate inhibitor is available for use (e.g., the rich and lean hydrate inhibitor tank volume measurements) and the concentration (e.g., potency) of the hydrate inhibitor. This information may likewise be fed into the modeling programs enabling the modeling programs to provide feedback to an operator about whether there is enough hydrate inhibitor for future hydrate prevention scenarios (e.g., shut down, start up), warn a user to order more hydrate inhibitor, etc.

(44) In some embodiments, the additive management system **12** may include flow control devices **22** (e.g. chokes) that facilitate mixing between the hydrate inhibitor and the fluid flowing out of the well **32**. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may receive feedback from a sensor **14** and/or flow meter **20** that measures the concentration of hydrate inhibitor. If the measured concentration is more or less than the expected concentration based on feedback from the CIMV **16**, the controller **24** may adjust the flow control device **22** to increase mixing between the hydrate inhibitor and the fluid flow.

(45) FIG. **3** is a schematic view of an embodiment of the additive management system **12** coupled to a wellhead system **26**. As explained above, the additive management system **12** enables precise and/or targeted control of the hydrate formation throughout the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**, which reduces the amount of hydrate inhibitor used as well as the hydrate inhibitor infrastructure. Accordingly, FIG. **3** illustrates hydrate inhibitor injection into a specific wellhead system **26**.

(46) The additive management system **12** includes sensors **14**, a flow meter **20**, and a CIMV **16** that couple to a controller **24**. In operation, the flow meter **20** measures the flow rate of fluid exiting the well **32**. In some embodiments, the flow meter **20** may be a wet-gas flow meter or multi-phase flow meter capable of measuring a fluid flow rate as well as the concentration of water in the fluid flow. In addition, the controller **24** receives feedback from additional sensors **14**. For example, the additive management system **12** may include a pressure sensor, a temperature sensor, a conductivity probe, a solid particulate sensor, and a salinity sensor among others that couple to the wellhead system **26**. In some embodiments, the sensor **14** may be a conductivity probe **68** capable of measuring the concentrations of one or more components in the fluid flow. For example, in some embodiments, the conductivity probe **68** may be configured to measure low concentrations of water in the fluid flow. In certain embodiments, the sensor **14** may be an optical sensor **70**, which may be configured to measure the concentrations of one or more components in the fluid flow, such as the concentration of water. Moreover, in some embodiments, the conductivity probe **68**, the optical sensor **70**, and/or a wet-gas/multiphase flow meter **20** may be placed before the CIMV **16** to block inclusion of the hydrate inhibitor in the measurement of water content of the fluid flow.

(47) In operation, the controller **24** combines the information from the flow meter **20** (e.g., wet-gas flow meter, multi-phase flow meter) and the sensors **14** to determine how much hydrate inhibitor should be injected into the fluid flow. As explained above, the flow meter **20** measures the flow rate of fluid exiting the well **32** while the sensors **14** measure one or more environmental conditions (e.g., pressure, temperature, water content, salinity, etc.). In some embodiments, the additive management system **12** may include a sensor **14** (e.g., conductivity probe **68** and/or optical sensor **70**) configured to measure low concentrations of water in the fluid flow. In order to increase accurate measurement of the water content, the sensor **14** may be placed upstream from the CIMV **16** to block inclusion of the hydrate inhibitor in the water content measurement. In some embodiments, the additive management system **12** may also provide redundant measurement of hydrate inhibitor injection into the fluid flow. For example, the additive management system **12**

may receive feedback from the CIMV **16** as well as a flow meter **20** (e.g., an ultrasonic flow meter) to measure the flow rate of the injected hydrate inhibitor. As noted above, the controller **24** may be configured to compare the flow rate measured by the flow meter **20** to the set injection rate of the CIMV **16** to determine whether the CIMV **16** is injecting the hydrate inhibitor at the correct rate. The flow meter **20** may be disposed in the CIMV **16**, or may be disposed proximate to the CIMV **16** and directly upstream or downstream of the injected hydrate inhibitor such that the flow meter **20** receives the hydrate inhibitor before the hydrate inhibitor is injected into the fluid flow. In certain embodiments, the additive management system **12** may also include a sensor **14** (e.g., a conductivity probe **68**, an optical sensor **70**, etc.) to measure the concentration of hydrate inhibitor entering the fluid flow. In some embodiments, the flow meter **20** may be configured to measure the concentration of hydrate inhibitor entering the fluid flow. As explained above, by measuring the concentration (e.g., strength, potency) of the hydrate inhibitor before injection, the modeling programs are able to determine how much hydrate inhibitor should be injected to block hydrate formation. While FIG. 3 illustrates sensors **14** and the flow meter **20** coupled to the Christmas tree **30** (e.g., production tree), the sensors **14** and flow meter **20** may be coupled to other areas of the wellhead system **26** (e.g., wellhead **28**, jumper system **42**, etc.).

(48) FIG. 4 is a schematic view of an embodiment of the additive management system **12** coupled to a wellhead system **26**. The additive management system **12** includes sensors **14**, a flow meter **20**, and a CIMV **16** that couple to a controller **24**. In some embodiments, the additive management system **12** may include a sensor **14** (e.g., a conductivity probe **68** and/or an optical sensor **70**) downstream of the CIMV **16** to measure one or more flow parameters of the fluid flow after mixing with a chemical injected via the CIMV **16**. For example, the conductivity probe **68** and/or an optical sensor **70** may be configured to determine the water content, the hydrate inhibitor content, or an injected chemical content, as described above. In certain embodiments, the conductivity probe **68** and/or the optical sensor **70** may be configured to generate feedback that may be used by the controller **24** to determine a ratio of an injected chemical relative to water in the fluid flow. For example, the conductivity probe **68** may measure the electromagnetic properties of the mixed fluid (e.g., downstream of the CIMV **16**) at two different electromagnetic frequencies. The controller **24** may be configured to compare signals from the conductivity probe **68** at each frequency to determine a ratio of an injected chemical relative to water in the fluid flow based on the frequency-dependence of the measured electromagnetic properties. The controller **24** may be configured to use one or more algorithms (e.g., to calculate the fluid conductivity, fluid permittivity, and/or complex reflection coefficient), look-up tables (e.g., including empirical data), models, and so forth to derive the ratio of the injected chemical relative to water based on the electromagnetic properties. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may compare signals at different wavelengths (e.g., two or more wavelengths) from the optical sensor **70** to determine a ratio of an injected chemical relative to water in the fluid flow. As will be described in more detail below, the controller **24** may be configured to adjust the injection rate of an injected chemical or to provide a recommendation to adjust the injection rate of an injected chemical to achieve a desired ratio of injected chemical to water in the fluid flow.

(49) FIG. 5 is a schematic view of an embodiment of a section of the additive management system **12** coupled to a wellhead system **26**. The additive management system **12** includes sensors **14**, a flow meter **20**, a flow control device **22**, and a CIMV **16** that couple to a controller **24**. As illustrated, the additive management system **12** includes sensors **14** upstream and downstream of the CIMV **15**. For example, the additive management system **12** may include an upstream conductivity probe **68** and a downstream conductivity probe **68** and/or an upstream optical sensor **70** and a downstream optical sensor **70**. In this manner, the controller **24** may be configured to determine the water content in the fluid upstream of the CIMV **16**, the water content in the fluid downstream of the CIMV **16**, and the injected chemical content (e.g., the hydrate inhibitor content) in the fluid downstream of the CIMV **16**. Further, the controller **24** may be configured to determine

a ratio of an injected chemical relative to water in the fluid flow. For example, the controller **24** may determine or derive the electromagnetic properties of water based on feedback (e.g., a first signal) from an upstream conductivity probe **68**. Additionally, the controller **24** may be configured to determine or derive the electromagnetic properties of a water-chemical mixture based on feedback (e.g., a second signal) from a downstream conductivity probe **68**. Further, the controller **24** may be configured to compare the electromagnetic properties of the water with the electromagnetic properties of the water-chemical mixture to determine a ratio of injected chemical relative to water. Additionally or alternatively, the controller **24** may receive signals at multiple wavelengths from a downstream optical sensor **70**, and the controller **24** may analyze the signals at the multiple wavelengths to determine a ratio of injected chemical relative to water. For example, the upstream optical sensor **70** and/or the downstream optical sensor **70** may each be configured to emit at least a first wavelength corresponding to an absorption peak of water and a second wavelength corresponding to an absorption peak of the injected chemical. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may be configured to determine the ratio of the injected chemical to water based on the measured absorbance at each wavelength, the path lengths of water and the injected chemical, and the absorption coefficients of water and the injected chemical (e.g., using Beer-Lambert's law).

(50) In some embodiments, the additive management system **12** may include a flow control device **22**. As explained above, the flow control devices **22** (e.g. chokes) facilitate mixing between the injected chemical (e.g., hydrate inhibitor) and the fluid flowing out of the well **32**. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may use feedback from a sensor **14** (e.g., the conductivity probe **68** and/or the optical sensor **70**) downstream from the flow control device **22** to determine whether the injected chemical has mixed adequately with the fluid flow. If mixing is inadequate, the controller **24** may adjust the flow control device **22** to increase mixing between the fluid flow and the injected chemical.

(51) FIG. **6** is a cross-sectional view of an embodiment of a hanger **100** (e.g., a tubing hanger) of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. The tubing hanger **100** may include a production bore **102** (e.g., a main bore) and an outlet passageway **104** that branches off from the production bore **102**. Additionally, the tubing hanger **100** may include a wireline plug **106** configured to seal the production bore **102** above the outlet passageway **104**. Further, the tubing hanger **100** may include a CIMV **16** configured to inject a chemical into the outlet passageway **104**. To measure one or more properties of the fluid flow (e.g., water content) upstream of the injection point, the tubing hanger **100** may include one or more sensors **14** (e.g., a conductivity probe **68**) upstream of the injection point. In particular, a conductivity probe **68** may be disposed within the production bore **102**. In some embodiments, the conductivity probe **68** may be disposed within the production bore **102** below the wireline plug **106**. However, it should be appreciated that the additive management system **12** may include the sensors **14** in any suitable location about the tubing hanger **100**, such as in the outlet passageway **104** upstream of the CIMV **16** and/or in the outlet passageway **104** downstream of the CIMV **16**. Providing sensors **14** in the tubing hanger **100** may be desirable because the sensors **14** may be removable or retrievable with the tubing hanger **100**.

(52) FIG. **7** is an embodiment of a method **120** for controlling hydrate formation of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. The method **120** may be a computer-implemented method. For example, one or more steps of the method **120** may be executed using the controller **24** (e.g., the processor **60**) and/or the computer **74**. The method **120** may include receiving (block **122**) feedback from one or more sensors **14** and/or one or more flow meters **20** disposed in hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. Additionally, the method **120** may include determining (block **124**) one or more parameters based on the feedback. For example, the controller **24** may be configured to determine one or more parameters of a fluid flow in the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**, such as pressure, temperature, flow rate, fluid density, composition (e.g., water content, injected chemical content, hydrate inhibitor content, a ratio of an injected chemical to water, etc.), or any other suitable

parameter. Further, the method **120** may include determining (block **126**) a hydrate condition based on the one or more parameters. In particular, the controller **24** may estimate the likelihood of hydrate formation based on the one or more parameters using the one or more modeling programs, hydrate formation curves, algorithms, database, and/or look-up tables described in detail above. Additionally, the method **120** may include determining (block **128**) an amount and/or a flow rate (e.g., mass flow) of a hydrate inhibitor to inject based on the hydrate condition. In particular, the controller **24** may determine an amount and/or flow rate of a hydrate inhibitor to inject to reduce or block hydrate formation. The controller **24** may determine the amount and/or flow rate using the modeling programs and/or one or more algorithms, as noted above. Further, as noted above, the controller **24** may be configured to determine a hydrate condition and an amount and/or flow rate of hydrate inhibitor to inject for a plurality of locations about the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**.

(53) Additionally, in some embodiments, the method **120** may include providing (block **130**) an indication of the amount and/or flow rate of hydrate inhibitor to inject. For example, the controller **24** may cause the user interface **72** to display the indication. In this manner, an operator may view the recommended injection settings and may manually adjust the CIMVs **16** to the recommended injection settings or may provide inputs to the controller **24** to adjust the CIMVs **16** to the recommended settings. In certain embodiments, the method **120** may include adjusting (block **132**) the amount and/or flow rate of the hydrate inhibitor to inject. For example, the controller **24** may control the CIMVs **16** to adjust the amount and/or flow rate in a closed-loop control. Further, the method **120** may continue receiving feedback (block **122**), determining parameters (block **124**), determining the hydrate condition (block **126**), and determining an amount and/or flow rate of hydrate inhibitor (block **128**).

(54) FIG. **8** is an embodiment of a method **150** for controlling a ratio of an injected chemical relative to water (e.g., $\text{ratio} = \text{chemical} / \text{water}$) in a fluid flow of the hydrocarbon extraction system **10**. The method **150** may be a computer-implemented method. For example, one or more steps of the method **150** may be executed using the controller **24** (e.g., the processor **60**) and/or the computer **74**. The method **150** may include determining (block **152**) a ratio of an injected chemical relative to water in a fluid flow. In particular, the controller **24** may determine the ratio based at least in part on two electromagnetic radiation (EMR) signals. For example, the controller **24** may receive two EMR signals at two different frequencies from a conductivity probe **68** downstream of an injection point (e.g., downstream of a CIMV **16**) and may determine the ratio of the injected chemical relative to water based on a comparison of the electromagnetic properties in the fluid in the first EMR signal at the first frequency and the electromagnetic properties in the fluid in the second EMR signal at the second frequency. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may receive a first EMR signal from a conductivity probe **68** upstream of an injection point and a second EMR signal from a conductivity probe **68** downstream of the injection point, and the controller **24** may determine the ratio by comparing electromagnetic properties of the fluid in the first and second EMR signals. Further, in some embodiments, the controller **24** may receive a first EMR signal (e.g., a mid-infrared signal) from an optical sensor **70** upstream of an injection point and a second EMR signal (e.g., mid-infrared signal) from an optical sensor **70** downstream of the injection point, and the controller **24** may determine the ratio based at least in part on the absorbance of the two EMR signals, the absorption coefficient of the injected chemical, the absorption coefficient of water. In certain embodiments, the controller **24** may receive EMR signals (e.g., mid-infrared signals) at multiple wavelengths (e.g., at least two wavelengths) from an optical sensor **70** downstream of an injection point, and the controller **24** may determine the ratio based at least in part on the absorbance of the EMR signals at the multiple wavelengths, the absorption coefficient of the injected chemical, the absorption coefficient of water. Additionally, in some embodiments, the controller **24** may be configured to measure a property of the chemical prior to injection and may be configured to use the measured property in the determination of the ratio. In one

embodiment, the controller **24** may measure the water content of the injected chemical prior to injection. For example, as noted above, the lean hydrate inhibitor (e.g., mono-ethylene glycol, MEG) may still include some water after the regeneration process, so it may be desirable to determine the water content in the hydrate inhibitor prior to injection.

(55) Additionally, the method **150** may include determining (block **154**) whether the ratio is within a desired threshold or threshold range. For example, the threshold range may be between approximately 1:1000 and 1000:1, 1:500 and 500:1, 1:250 and 250:1, 1:100 and 100:1, 1:75 and 75:1, 1:50 and 50:1, 1:25 and 25:1, 1:10 and 10:1, 1:5 and 5:1, or any other suitable range. In one embodiment, the threshold (e.g., upper threshold or lower threshold) may be 1:1. In some embodiments, the threshold or threshold range may be based on the type of injected chemical. By way of example, MEG may have a threshold range that is between approximately 1:10 and 10:1, and kinetic hydrate inhibitors may have a threshold range between approximately 1:1 and 1:1000. Accordingly, the controller **24** may be configured to select a threshold range from the memory **62** based on the type of injected chemical.

(56) Further, in some embodiments, the method **150** may include providing (block **156**) an indication to adjust the injected chemical rate in response to a determination that the ratio is not within a desired threshold or threshold range. For example, the controller **24** may cause the user interface **72** to display the indication. In some embodiments, the controller **24** may determine an amount and/or flow rate of chemical to inject to achieve the desired ratio, and the controller **24** may cause the user interface **72** to display the recommended injection setting (e.g., amount and/or flow rate). Additionally, in some embodiments, the method **150** may include adjusting (block **158**) the amount and/or flow rate of the injected chemical to achieve the desired ratio. For example, the controller **24** may control one or more CIMVs **16** to adjust an amount and/or flow rate of the injected chemical.

(57) While the invention may be susceptible to various modifications and alternative forms, specific embodiments have been shown by way of example in the drawings and have been described in detail herein. However, it should be understood that the invention is not intended to be limited to the particular forms disclosed. Rather, the invention is to cover all modifications, equivalents, and alternatives falling within the spirit and scope of the invention as defined by the following appended claims.

Claims

1. A hydrocarbon extraction system, comprising: an additive management system configured to oversee hydrate formation in the hydrocarbon extraction system, the additive management system comprising: a first sensor disposed in a wellhead system and configured to generate feedback relating to at least one parameter of a fluid flowing through the hydrocarbon extraction system; a first chemical injection device configured to inject a hydrate inhibitor into the fluid at a first location, where the first chemical injection device is positioned proximate to and downstream from the wellhead system; a memory storing a plurality of modeling programs for determining a likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid using different parameters of the fluid; and a controller configured to: receive the feedback from the first sensor; select, from the plurality of modeling programs stored in the memory, a first modeling program for determining a likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid at the first location using the feedback from the first sensor; execute the first modeling program to determine the likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid at the first location using the feedback from the first sensor; and determine a flow rate of hydrate inhibitor to inject into the fluid using the first chemical injection device based on the likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid at the first location.
2. The hydrocarbon extraction system of claim 1, wherein the controller is configured to control the chemical injection device to inject the hydrate inhibitor at the determined flow rate.

3. The hydrocarbon extraction system of claim 1, comprising a user interface operatively coupled to the controller, wherein the controller is configured to cause the user interface to display a recommendation to adjust the flow rate of the hydrate inhibitor to the determined flow rate.
4. The hydrocarbon extraction system of claim 1, wherein the first sensor is a conductivity probe, and wherein the controller is configured to: determine a proportion of water in the fluid based on the feedback from the conductivity probe; select, from the plurality of modeling programs stored in the memory, the first modeling program for determining the likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid at the first location using the proportion of water in the fluid; and execute the first modeling program to determine the likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid at the first location using the proportion of water in the fluid.
5. The hydrocarbon extraction system of claim 1, wherein the first sensor is configured to measure temperature and pressure, and wherein the additive management system comprises a second sensor configured to measure a third parameter of the fluid, wherein the controller is configured to: select, from the plurality of modeling programs stored in the memory, the first modeling program for determining the likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid at the first location using the feedback from the first sensor and additional feedback from the second sensor; and execute the first modeling program to determine the likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid at the first location using the feedback from the first sensor and the additional feedback from the second sensor.
6. The hydrocarbon extraction system of claim 1, wherein the additive management system comprises: a second sensor configured to generate additional feedback relating to at least one additional parameter of the fluid flowing through the hydrocarbon extraction system; a second chemical injection device configured to inject the hydrate inhibitor into the fluid at a second location; wherein the controller is configured to: receive the additional feedback from the second sensor; select, from the plurality of modeling programs stored in the memory, a second modeling program for determining a likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid at the second location using the additional feedback from the second sensor; execute the second modeling program to determine the likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid at the second location using the additional feedback from the second sensor; and determine a second flow rate of the hydrate inhibitor to inject into the fluid using the second chemical injection device based on the likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid at the second location, wherein the first sensor is proximate to the first chemical injection device and the second sensor is proximate to the second chemical injection device.
7. The hydrocarbon extraction system of claim 6, wherein the second location is on a manifold in communication with the wellhead system through a jumper system.
8. The hydrocarbon extraction system of claim 6, wherein the second location is on a second wellhead system and the first and second wellhead systems are coupled to a manifold.
9. The hydrocarbon extraction system of claim 8, wherein the manifold is located at a third location and comprises: a third sensor configured to generate additional feedback relating to at least one additional parameter of the fluid flowing through the hydrocarbon extraction system; a third chemical injection device configured to inject the hydrate inhibitor into the fluid at the third location; wherein the controller is configured to: receive the additional feedback from the third sensor; select, from the plurality of modeling programs stored in the memory, a third modeling program for determining a likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid at the third location using the additional feedback from the third sensor; execute the third modeling program to determine the likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid at the third location using the additional feedback from the third sensor; and determine a third flow rate of the hydrate inhibitor to inject into the fluid using the third chemical injection device based on the likelihood of hydrate formation at the third location, wherein the third sensor is proximate to the third chemical injection device.
10. The hydrocarbon extraction system of claim 1, wherein the controller is configured to execute each modeling program of the plurality of modeling programs to determine the flow rate of the hydrate inhibitor to inject into the fluid, wherein each modeling program of the plurality of

modeling programs is configured to determine a different flow rate of the hydrate inhibitor to inject for a start-up condition of the hydrocarbon extraction system, a steady-state condition of the hydrocarbon extraction system, or a shut-in condition of the hydrocarbon extraction system.

11. A system, comprising: a controller configured to: receive a first feedback from a flow meter, wherein the first feedback is indicative of a flow rate of a first fluid flowing through a conduit of a hydrocarbon extraction system; receive a second feedback from a first sensor, wherein the second feedback is indicative of a pressure, a temperature, or a water content of the first fluid; receive a third feedback from a second sensor, wherein the third feedback is indicative of a concentration of a hydrate inhibitor within a second fluid; determine an amount and timing of injection of the hydrate inhibitor from a chemical injection metering device into the conduit to mix with the first fluid using the first feedback and the second feedback; and control a choke to increase mixing of the second fluid in the conduit to mix the hydrate inhibitor with the first fluid based on the third feedback; wherein the first sensor is disposed in a wellhead system and the wellhead system is positioned proximate to and upstream from the chemical injection metering device.

12. The system of claim 11, wherein the first sensor comprises a pressure sensor or a temperature sensor, and the second feedback comprises the pressure or the temperature.

13. The system of claim 11, wherein the controller is configured to execute a modeling program using the first feedback from the flow meter and the second feedback from the first sensor to determine a likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid and to control the amount and timing of the injection of the hydrate inhibitor to reduce the likelihood of hydrate formation in the fluid.

14. A method for managing hydrate formation in a hydrocarbon extraction system, the method comprising: receiving a flow rate of a first fluid from a flow meter; receiving an environmental condition from a first sensor; identifying a hydrate formation condition using the flow rate and the environmental condition; obtaining a concentration of a hydrate inhibitor within a second fluid; controlling injection of the hydrate inhibitor via a chemical injection metering device into the first fluid in response to the hydrate formation condition; and adjusting a choke to increase mixing of the hydrate inhibitor in response to the concentration of the hydrate inhibitor within the second fluid.

15. The method of claim 14, wherein the environmental condition comprises temperature, pressure, or both.

16. The method of claim 15, comprising: receiving the environmental condition from the first sensor; and receiving a fluid condition from a second sensor.

17. The method of claim 16, wherein the fluid condition comprises water content and further comprising identifying the hydrate formation condition using the flow rate, the environmental condition, and the water content.

18. The method of claim 14, wherein the first sensor comprises at least one of a pressure sensor, a temperature sensor, a conductivity probe, or a salinity sensor.
